Retirement Cockpit

Setup & User Guide — plan a tax-efficient UK retirement income, on your computer and iPhone.

What this app is

Retirement Cockpit is a self-contained planning app in a single HTML file. It models a UK household's retirement income — pensions, ISAs, taxable investments, EIS/VCT, NS&I Premium Bonds, CGT-free gold and silver coins, cash and crypto — and works out, year by year, where your income comes from and what tax it attracts, using each person's personal allowance, 25% tax-free pension withdrawals, and a tax-optimised drawdown order. Everything runs on your own device: no account, no server, and none of your figures are sent anywhere.

It is a planning model, not financial advice. It uses 2025/26 allowances held flat and simplified UFPLS-style pension withdrawals. Before acting on big decisions — lump sums, pension contributions, drawdown method — see a regulated independent financial adviser.

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1 · Setup

You can use the Cockpit two ways: open the HTML file directly on a computer, or host it once and install it on your iPhone as a home-screen app with its own icon, full screen and offline support.

A. Just open the file (computer)

1. Save **retirement-cockpit.html** anywhere on your computer.
2. Double-click to open it in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, Firefox).
3. Your changes autosave in that browser and are restored when you reopen the file.

B. Host it and install on an iPhone

The app ships as a seven-file package (index.html, manifest.json, sw.js, three icons, and this guide's companion SETUP-GUIDE.md). The hosted copy contains **no personal data** — your figures are loaded on the phone afterwards and stay there.

1. Create a free account at **github.com** and make a new **public** repository (e.g. “cockpit”).
2. Upload all seven files from the zip to the repository root and commit.
3. In the repository: Settings > Pages > Branch “main”, folder “/ (root)” > Save.
4. Wait a minute; the Pages screen shows your address, e.g. **https://yourname.github.io/cockpit/**. If you get a 404, check the files are at the repository root (not inside a folder) and that the build has finished under the Actions tab.
5. On the iPhone, open that address in **Safari** (it must be Safari).
6. Tap Share > **Add to Home Screen** > Add. The Cockpit icon appears; opening it runs full-screen and works offline after the first visit.

Alternative host: drag the folder onto app.netlify.com/drop for an instant address. Updating later: upload the new index.html and sw.js over the old ones; open the app online once and it refreshes itself.

2 · Getting your data in

- On the computer where your figures already live: Reports > **Save scenario (JSON)**.
- Send the file to the phone privately — AirDrop is ideal (it never touches the internet).
- In the phone app: Reports > **Load scenario (JSON)** > pick the file. From then on the phone autosaves its own copy.

Never upload your scenario JSON to the public repository — it holds your real figures. Phone and computer each keep their own data; move changes between them with Save/Load scenario, or “Download app + data (HTML)” for an all-in-one private file.

3 · The income tuner

The dark band at the top is the whole plan in one line.

- **Income slider** — your target monthly income after tax, in today's money. Drag it and everything recalculates.
- **Plan funded to age** — the gold number. Click it, type a target age (say 90), and the app solves the highest monthly income that lasts to that age — the slider snaps to the answer.
- **Pot at retirement** and **first-year income tax** complete the headline.
- The countdown pill counts days and hours to your retirement date (set per person in Settings).

4 · Portfolio

Holdings are grouped by wrapper, each with a colour dot and group subtotal. The green tile shows the holdings count.

Views and editing

- Toggle **line view** (table) and **tile view** with the two icons top-left of the card; set the default in Settings.
- Line view edits in place; the up/down arrows reorder within a wrapper group; the X deletes (with confirmation).
- Tile view: tap a tile to edit everything in a pop-up — including a **notes** field where URLs become clickable links. Empty notes show a “+ Add note” button.
- Filter by **owner** (you / partner / joint) and **wrapper**; filters drive the KPI tiles and totals. Filters are a view — the projection always models the whole household.

Wrappers and how they're taxed

Wrapper	Withdrawals in the model	Notes
Pension (SIPP)	25% tax-free; rest at owner's marginal rate	Personal; fills unused personal allowance first
ISA	Tax-free	£20,000 allowance per person per year
GIA / Investment (taxable)	Effective tax % you set (default 5%)	Approximates CGT above the £3,000 allowance
EIS Investment	Tax-free (3-year hold assumed)	30% relief on subscription; illiquid; drawn late
VCT	Tax-free; dividends tax-free	30% relief, 5-year hold; listed, drawn before EIS
Gold/silver coins	Tax-free	Sovereigns/Britannias are CGT-exempt
Cash	Tax-free	Drawn first
NS&I Premium Bonds	Tax-free	£50,000 cap per person; prizes tax-free
Crypto	Effective tax % (as GIA)	Priced live per coin

Live UK data (collapsible card)

- **Refresh** fetches the official ONS CPI rate (one tap sets it as your inflation assumption), gold and silver £/oz, and a live price for each crypto holding's own coin.
- Enter troy ounces in the Gold and Silver rows and coins per crypto row; **Apply live prices** revalues the holdings. “+ Add coin” tracks another cryptocurrency as its own holding — existing coins are never overwritten.
- The **estimate (CAGR)** button on taxable investments estimates annual growth (CAGR) from what you paid vs what it's worth — e.g. for NVIDIA shares.

Fund and share prices have no free keyless feed, so update those holding values by hand (or via the estimator).

5 · Plan & tax levers

- **Before retirement:** one-off pension contribution (with tax-relief rate and which cash pot funds it) and the annual Bed-&-ISA move (£20k per person per year).
- **In retirement:** annual extras (holidays etc.), one-off major expenses with category icons, years and notes, the drawdown strategy, inflation, and the effective tax rate on taxable accounts.
- **Drawdown order (tax-optimised):** fill each person's personal allowance from pension (zero tax), then cash, Premium Bonds, ISA, gold, VCT, EIS, taxed pots, and finally further taxed pension, always from whoever pays less tax.

6 · Actions

- Tiles for the run-up to retirement — tap one for detailed guidance and a notes pad.
- Set a **due date** on each; tiles turn amber inside your 1st Alert window and red when overdue, with a banner summary.
- **Add reminders to calendar (.ics)** — your 1st and 2nd Alerts plus a due-day ping arrive via your phone's calendar even when the app is closed. **Email me what's due** drafts a summary to your Settings email.
- Ticking the pension-contribution or ISA actions **executes them**: holdings update, the lever retires (no double-count), and a green note confirms.
- Completed actions move to the **archive** (bottom of the section) — restore reverses any portfolio effect exactly; delete is permanent.

7 · Projection

- **Wealth chart:** stacked pot balances by age, with the “retire” marker. Colours match the wrapper dots.
- **Income composition chart:** each retirement year's income by source — state pensions (green); salary, pensions in payment & other income (gold); zero-tax pension drawdown (teal); savings/ISA/other pots (blue) — against the dashed spending-target line. The gap above the line is income tax.
- **Year-by-year table:** need, state pension, **fixed income** (pensions in payment + part-time income + salary, excluding state pension), pension draw, tax-free draws, income tax, then every pot. One-off expenses show their category icons.
- **Show figures in today's money** strips inflation out of every displayed figure; the simulation itself is unchanged.

8 · Settings reference (grouped and collapsible)

- **You:** name, email (used on printed reports), date of birth (auto-fills age), retirement date (day/month/year — drives the countdown, salary cut-off and drawdown start), salary, pensions in payment (several, each with £/month and start month), other income after retirement (each with £/month and a from–to range, taxed), state pension and its age.
- **Spouse / partner:** the couple toggle plus the same fields. Couple mode gives two personal allowances, two state pensions, a £40k household ISA rate, an Owner column, and a working partner's salary offsetting the need.
- **Display & app:** default holdings view (line/tiles), app version label (shows right of the menu bar), collapsible main sections.
- **Action alerts:** 1st Alert and 2nd Alert in days — drive tile colours, the banner, the email summary and the calendar alarms. 2nd never exceeds 1st; 0 skips it.
- **Plan horizon:** run the projection to any age 80–105.

9 · Reports, backups and resets

- **Download app + data (HTML)** — a copy of the whole app with your data baked in; opens anywhere with everything intact. Keep it private.
- **Download projection (CSV)** — the full year-by-year model including the FixedIncome column and one-off events.
- **Save / Load scenario (JSON)** — your portable backup and the way to move data between devices.
- **Print / save as PDF report** — a clean printout headed “Prepared for …” using your Settings names and emails.

- **Reset to defaults** — back to this file's built-in starting figures. **Clear all personal data** — wipes to a blank, generic app (for handing the device or file on); both double-confirm, and the clear dialog offers a one-tap JSON backup first.

Autosave runs on every change and flushes when you close or switch away. It lives in that browser on that device — clearing the browser's site data removes it, so keep an occasional JSON export as the backup of record.

10 · Troubleshooting

- **“Add to Home Screen” is missing:** You're in Chrome or an in-app browser; open the address in Safari.
- **GitHub address shows 404:** Files must sit at the repository root; wait for the Pages build (Actions tab); use the exact URL from Settings > Pages.
- **Phone shows an old version:** Open the address in Safari while online and refresh once; the icon then serves the new version.
- **Live data won't refresh:** You're offline, or the source is briefly down — last saved figures stay in place; try later.
- **My data vanished:** “Clear History and Website Data” on iPhone wipes app storage. Restore via Load scenario (JSON).
- **A coin/metal didn't revalue:** Enter its units and hit Refresh first — a price that hasn't been fetched is never applied.
- **Figures look too optimistic:** Check growth assumptions (the ≈ estimator warns on hot streaks) and view in today's money.

Retirement Cockpit is a planning model using 2025/26 UK tax parameters (personal allowance £12,570, basic-rate band to £50,270, ISA £20,000, pension annual allowance £60,000, CGT allowance £3,000, full new state pension £11,973/yr). Rules change; verify at gov.uk and take regulated advice before acting.